

Cliff Bates

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EXECUTIVE IT LEADER

Executive technology leader with 25+ years in regulated financial services, including more than a decade at the executive level. Led enterprise infrastructure, cyber-resilience, core banking modernization, technology governance, and examination readiness for a major regional banking organization. Trusted advisor to C-suite and board-level leaders, translating technology investment into operational resilience, risk reduction, and business agility.

Executive Core Competencies

- **Strategic Leadership:** Enterprise IT Strategy & Vision | Board and Executive Alignment | C-Suite Advisory | Technology Governance | AI Governance and Responsible Adoption | Organizational Leadership
- **Operations & Financial Stewardship:** Large Operating Budget Management | Strategic Vendor and Contract Management | Cloud and Platform Modernization | Active/Active Multi-Site Data Center Resilience | High-Availability Infrastructure | M&A Technology Integration
- **Risk, Security & Resilience:** Cyber Vulnerability Remediation | Information Security and Cyber Defense | Regulatory Compliance and Examination Readiness (FDIC/FFIEC/GLBA) | Disaster Recovery and Business Continuity | Enterprise and Third-Party Risk Management | Crisis and Incident Management
- **Modernization & Transformation:** Core Systems Transformation | Enterprise Architecture | Data and Analytics Leadership | Digital Employee and Customer Experience | Technology Operating Models

Executive Leadership & Experience

03/2025 – Present Executive Career Transition & Professional Development

Undertook an intentional sabbatical focused on strategic executive networking, global travel, and staying abreast of emerging enterprise technology trends prior to market re-entry.

12/2017 – 03/2025 Executive Vice President, Enterprise Infrastructure & Technology - Zions Bancorporation — Salt Lake City, UT

- **Enterprise Operations:** Directed enterprise IT infrastructure operations, technology governance, and data center strategy supporting 450+ financial locations and 20,000+ technology components.
- **Financial Stewardship:** Managed an annual operating budget exceeding \$100M, optimizing cost structures and vendor licensing efficiency while maintaining continuous high availability.
- **Data Center Resilience:** Architectural leader behind transforming Zions' infrastructure from active/passive to an active/active multi-data center model, achieving non-disruptive uptime.
- **Cyber Vulnerability Remediation:** Spearheaded enterprise-wide patching and threat mitigation across 20,000+ components in close partnership with corporate cybersecurity teams.
- **Audit & Governance:** Deployed a risk management governance framework across 200+ staff, producing measurable audit rating improvements across enterprise environments.

03/2013 – 12/2017 Senior Vice President, Core Technical Readiness - Zions Bancorporation — Salt Lake City, UT

- **Core Banking Modernization:** Partnered with the Enterprise CIO to execute Releases 1 & 2 of the multi-year FutureCore TCS BaNCS deployment.
- **Development & Testing Leadership:** Led a team of developers and testers through the full conversion — directing technical architecture, interface development, and functional and non-functional testing, while managing integration with our offshore partner TCS.

2011 – 03/2013 - Vice President, IT Enterprise Communications Manager Sr. - Zions Bancorporation — Salt Lake City, UT

- **Enterprise Communications, Data & Networking:** Managed teams overseeing enterprise communications infrastructure, including IVR, VoIP/telephony systems, networking, storage, and backup frameworks.

2004 – 2011 - Vice President, IT Manager - Zions Bancorporation — Salt Lake City, UT

- **Data Storage, Movement & Authentication:** Led Data Transmission Services, Storage Infrastructure, and Distributed Enterprise Services across the corporation.

2000 – 2004 - IT Systems Engineer - Zions Bancorporation — Salt Lake City, UT

- **Server Administration:** Supported data-center server environments, remote offices, and technical integration during the Zions & First Security merger.

1998 - 2000 - IT Consultant - Uinta Business Systems - Contractor to Zions Bancorporation and other Utah-based companies — Salt Lake City, UT

- **Consulting** — Systems Administration, Network Design & Security

Education & Community Leadership

Bachelor of Science: Business Management — University of Phoenix, Salt Lake City, UT (2009)

Executive & Community Involvement:

- Co-Chair, Zions Bank Paint-a-Thon
- Member, Zions Peer Bank Forum (MAAG)
- Leadership Involvement, ZTC Building Committee

References

Available upon request